



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Aviation Identity Phishing and Remote Tool Abuse Daily Review 2026-09-17

Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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1. Executive Summary

BLUF: Identity phishing, helpdesk social engineering, and remote monitoring/management abuse remain practical intrusion paths for aviation and aerospace operations. Operators should validate helpdesk reset controls, RMM inventory, conditional access, and high-risk sign-in response. Source recency was prioritized for the last 24-72 hours and expanded to the last 7 days or current public reference material where required to preserve source quality.

Field	Value
Priority	Top 5 aviation/aerospace coverage for 2026-09-17
Severity	High
Confidence	Medium
Theme	Airlines, airport operators, ground handlers, travel services, MRO providers, and aerospace suppliers
Defender Outcome	Prioritized monitoring, hardening, and response actions for the next 24-72 hours

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By
What changed?	Current reporting and public source review for 2026-09-17
Who is exposed?	Organizations with the listed technologies, behaviors, identities, suppliers, or sector dependencies
What should defenders do today?	Validate controls, run hunts, close exceptions, and brief operations owners

3. Source Review and Confidence

#	Source	URL	Role
1	CISO Series September 14 2026 cybersecurity news	https://cisoserries.com/cybersecurity-news-september-14-2026/	Current phishing/cloud-account trigger
2	CISA phishing-resistant MFA guidance	https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/resources/phishing-resistant-mfa-fact-sheet	Government MFA guidance
3	PolySwarm aviation/aerospace threat overview	https://blog.polyswarm.io/turbulence-ahead-cyber-threats-targeting-aviation-and-aerospace-in-2026	Sector relevance
4	Microsoft Entra ID Protection documentation	https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-protection/	Identity detection/control reference

Confidence is Medium because this item is supported by multiple public sources. Where a source is sector-level or advisory guidance rather than incident-specific reporting, the report labels the finding as a prioritization assessment rather than a confirmed single campaign.

4. Threat Overview

Identity phishing, helpdesk social engineering, and remote monitoring/management abuse remain practical intrusion paths for aviation and aerospace operations. Operators should validate helpdesk reset controls, RMM inventory, conditional access, and high-risk sign-in response. This report emphasizes defender actions and telemetry pivots rather than attribution claims that are not supported by the source set.

Signal	Assessment
Threat theme	Sector-focused cyber risk
Primary exposure	Identity, exposed services, remote access, endpoint execution, third-party access, or software supply chain depending on environment
Expected adversary objective	Access, persistence, data theft, extortion, operational disruption, or reconnaissance
Analyst caveat	No new private telemetry or victim disclosure was used in this automated report; validate local relevance before escalation

5. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

Field	Assessment
Affected aviation/aerospace segment	Airlines, airport operators, ground handlers, travel services, MRO providers, and aerospace suppliers
Operational relevance	Potential disruption to flight operations support, maintenance scheduling, engineering collaboration, passenger/cargo services, or mission operations depending on local exposure
Likely exposure paths	Identity compromise, remote access, exposed edge services, supplier portals, managed service providers, and shared SaaS platforms
Third-party/supply-chain considerations	Validate providers that administer identity, helpdesk, reservation, MRO, engineering, remote access, and monitoring systems
Defender actions	Confirm MFA/session controls, privileged access logging, asset ownership, segmentation, backup recoverability, and incident escalation paths

6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic/Technique	Defensive Interpretation
Phishing / social engineering	Review user-reported messages, suspicious OAuth grants, helpdesk reset requests, and anomalous sign-ins
Command and scripting execution	Watch for encoded PowerShell, mshta/rundll32, shell one-liners, and living-off-the-land tools
Remote services and RMM	Inventory approved remote tools and alert on new or unmanaged

	usage
Exfiltration or staging	Monitor unusual archive creation, cloud upload, rclone/mega/nc usage, and large outbound transfers

7. Infrastructure and Observables

Observable	Type	Action
passkey phishing	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
RMM tool	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
helpdesk reset	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
airline identity	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry

8. Detection Engineering

```

let pivots = dynamic(["passkey phishing", "RMM tool", "helpdesk reset", "airline identity"]);
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any (pivots) or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any (pivots)
| summarize Events=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Samples=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 10) by
FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName
| order by Events desc

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where RemoteUrl has_any ("passkey phishing", "RMM tool", "helpdesk reset", "airline identity") or
InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("passkey phishing", "RMM tool", "helpdesk reset", "airline
identity")
| summarize Events=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Urls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteIP, RemotePort
| order by Events desc

title: Aviation Identity Phishing RMM Abuse Suspicious Follow-on Activity
status: experimental
description: Detects common suspicious interpreter and remote-tool behaviors that should be reviewed
around this daily intelligence item.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  keywords:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - ' -enc'
      - 'IEX'
      - 'DownloadString'
      - 'bitsadmin'
      - 'curl '

```

```

- 'rclone'
condition: selection or keywords
fields:
- Image
- ParentImage
- CommandLine
- User
level: medium

```

9. Threat Hunting

```

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| where ResultType != 0 or ConditionalAccessStatus in ("failure", "notApplied")
| summarize Events=count(), Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 20) by
UserPrincipalName, Location
| order by Events desc

DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName endswith ".zip" or FileName endswith ".7z" or FolderPath has_any ("Temp", "Downloads",
"Users\Public")
| summarize Files=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Samples=make_set(FolderPath, 10) by
InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName
| order by Files desc

```

Hunt intent: surface identity compromise, suspicious scripting, remote-tool abuse, and staging behavior aligned to this daily priority.

10. Risk Assessment

Risk	Why It Matters	First Control Check
Identity compromise	Enables SaaS, VPN, helpdesk, and supplier access	MFA/session policy, risky sign-ins, privileged accounts
Endpoint execution	Converts social engineering into payload execution	Script controls, EDR alerts, child-process lineage
Third-party dependency	Expands blast radius beyond direct assets	Vendor access inventory and contractual incident notification
Operational disruption	Affects business processes and customer-facing services	Recovery tests, escalation paths, communication plans

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Action
P1	Run the included identity/process/network hunts for the last 14 days
P2	Validate asset owners and control exceptions for the exposed surface
P3	Brief service desk, SOC, and operations owners on concrete pivots
P4	Open remediation tickets with expiry dates for unresolved gaps

12. References

- [1] CISO Series September 14 2026 cybersecurity news: <https://cisoserries.com/cybersecurity-news-september-14-2026/>

- [2] CISA phishing-resistant MFA guidance: <https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/resources/phishing-resistant-mfa-fact-sheet>
- [3] PolySwarm aviation/aerospace threat overview: <https://blog.polyswarm.io/turbulence-ahead-cyber-threats-targeting-aviation-and-aerospace-in-2026>
- [4] Microsoft Entra ID Protection documentation: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-protection/>